

Chapter 13: Bicycle Laws and Safety

Bicycle Traffic Laws

A bicycle is a vehicle. Any person riding a bicycle has the same rights and responsibilities that apply to a driver operating a vehicle unless these cannot, by their nature, apply to a person operating a bicycle.

Any person who operates a bicycle is subject to the same penalties for violating a traffic law as a person operating a motor vehicle. All traffic convictions will be placed on the individual's driver record, regardless if the conviction was for an offense committed on a bicycle or in a motor vehicle.

Do's

1. Always obey all traffic laws, signs, and signals. Stop at all stop signs and red lights.
2. Always ride with the flow of traffic.
3. Only ride on or astride a permanent and regular seat.
4. When operating a bicycle on a one-way road with two or more marked traffic lanes, ride as near as possible to the left curb or edge of the road.
5. Individuals riding two abreast on a "laned" road must ride in a single lane and not impede the flow of traffic.
6. Bicyclists may ride on the shoulder of the road.
7. Bicyclists must signal a turn or stop by:
 - a. Using either their left arm pointing up or their right arm pointed horizontally to signal a right turn.
 - b. Using their left arm pointed horizontally to signal a left turn.
 - c. Using their left arm pointed downward to signal a stop.
8. A person operating a bicycle who is moving slower than the other traffic on the road shall ride as near as possible to the right curb or edge of the road unless:
 - a. The person is overtaking and passing another vehicle proceeding in the same direction
 - b. The person is preparing for a left turn at an intersection or onto a private road or driveway
 - c. There are unsafe conditions in the road such as fixed or moving objects, parked or moving vehicles, pedestrians, animals, potholes, or debris, or
 - d. The person is operating a bicycle in an outside lane that is:
 - Less than 14 feet in width and doesn't have a designated bicycle lane adjacent to that lane; or
 - The lane is too narrow for a bicycle and a motor vehicle to safely travel side by side.

Don'ts

1. Never carry more than the number of individuals it is designated or equipped for.
2. Never ride opposite the flow of traffic.
3. Never attach the bicycle or person to a moving streetcar or vehicle upon a road.
4. Never carry any package, bundle, or article which prevents the rider from keeping at least one hand on the handlebars.

Shared Lane Marking

The shared lane marking may be used to:

1. Assist bicyclists with lateral positioning in a shared lane with on-street parallel parking in order to reduce the chance of a bicyclist impacting the open door of a parked vehicle
2. Assist bicyclists with lateral position in lanes too narrow for a motor vehicle and a bicycle to travel side by side within the same traffic lane
3. Alert road users of the lateral location bicyclists are likely to occupy within the traveled way
4. Encourage safe passing of bicyclists by motorists, or
5. Reduce the incidence of wrong-way bicycling

Shared Lane Marking

